

FLASH GOOD PRACTICE

Fall prevention of objects installed above voids



Objects installed above voids, such as floodlights, antennas, survey prisms...etc, are potential sources of **dropped objects that may lead to severe accidents**. Accidents and Hipo near-misses that occurred on our construction sites demonstrate that this is a **significant risk**, and the implementation of best practices to prevent it is necessary.

To minimise risks, multiple approaches are possible, such as :

- **Reduce the installation of equipment at height** by using alternative solutions
- **Use reliable fixings** (e.g. safety chains, bolted supports...etc) - Avoid the use of cable clips, as they are often unsafely used and source of instability
- **Mitigate the consequences of a dropped object** by installing barriers or safety nets
- **Integrate this equipment into a documented inspection routine**, the frequency of which will depend on criteria such as the potential consequences of a dropped object ~~fall~~, their duration of presence on site, and exposure to weather, corrosion, vibrations, impacts from personnel/vehicles, etc
- **Ensure a simple and secure means of access** for preventive & corrective maintenance operations of such equipment
- **Take this equipment into account when preparing lifting plans** to avoid any clashes with loads and lifting arrangements



Example of floodlights above a void unsafely fixed with cable clips, and the modified configuration for secure mounting



Example of unsafe access to a spotlight